

Lab: Moving from the Inside Out

Objective

Explore embodied action through movement lab that reveals how movement arises from inner impulse, engages with environmental affordances, and unfolds through the sensorimotor loop, through the lens of dance, yoga, martial arts.

Prerequisites

- A quiet, comfortable space for 25 minutes
- Willingness to engage in movement lab
- No prior experience required

Part 1: Arriving (5 minutes)

Stand in a comfortable position. Shake out your hands and feet gently. Roll your shoulders. Take three breaths. Begin to sway gently, finding your body's natural rhythm of movement.

Do not decide to move. Wait for your body to want to move. When the impulse comes, follow it. Let the body lead.

Write your response here

(What was the first impulse? Where in your body did it begin? What was the quality of the movement that followed?)

Part 2: Affordances (7 minutes)

Through dance, yoga, martial arts, explore how the environment invites action. Look around your space. Notice what each surface, object, and opening offers your body. Follow at least three affordances -- sit, lean, reach, grasp.

Write your response here

(List three affordances you noticed. How did your body and the environment cooperate to produce action?)

Part 3: Effort and Flow (7 minutes)

Perform a familiar action the natural way (flowing). Then try it an awkward way (effortful). Through dance, yoga, martial arts, notice the difference in prediction error.

Write your response here

(Describe the felt difference between flowing and effortful action. What does effort tell you about the body's predictions?)

Part 4: Reflection (5 minutes)

Through dance, yoga, martial arts, reflect on what action means.

Write your response here

(Is action something you do, or something that unfolds through you? How does dance, yoga, martial arts illuminate the nature of embodied action?)

Reflection Table

Dimension	What I Noticed	Active Inference Connection
Initial awareness		Baseline generative model state
Embodied exploration		Prediction error through direct experience
Dance, yoga, martial arts lens		Course-specific perspective on action
Integration		Updated understanding through bodily knowing

Discussion

Consider how dance, yoga, martial arts reveals aspects of action that other perspectives might miss. In Active Inference, every perspective changes the precision weighting of different signals, revealing different dimensions of the same underlying process of free energy minimization.